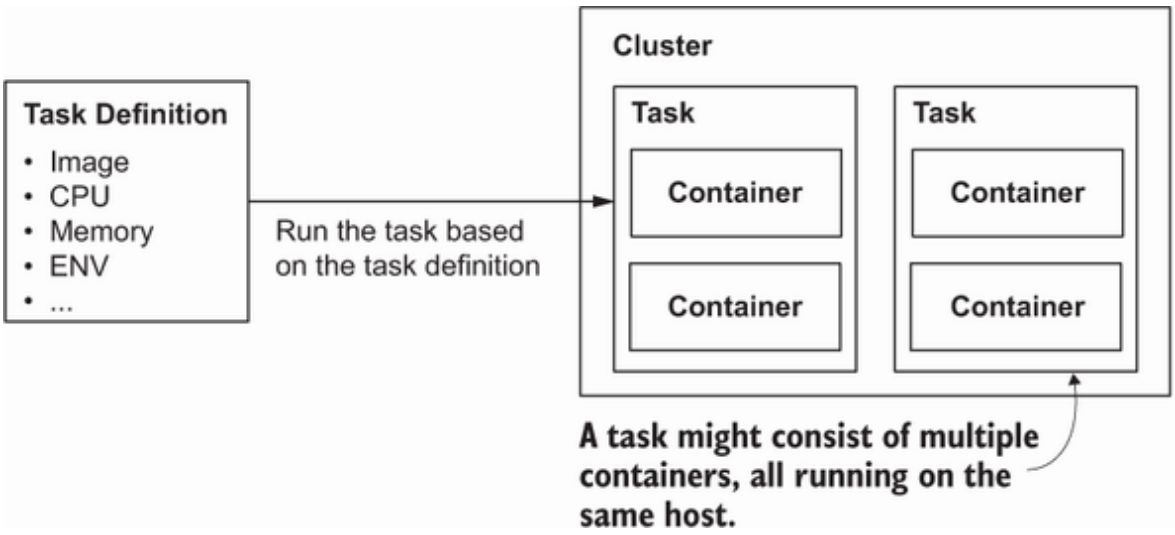


Figure 18.3 A task definition defines all the details needed to create a task, which consists of one or multiple containers.

Next, you are ready to create a task. To do so, you need to specify the cluster as well as the task definition. After you create the task, ECS will try to run the containers as specified. Note that all containers defined in a task definition will run on the same host. This is important if you have multiple containers that need to share local resources—the local network, for example. Figure 18.3 shows how to run tasks based on a task definition.

Luckily, you can, but do not have to, create tasks manually. Suppose you want to deploy a web server on ECS. In this case, you need to ensure that at least two containers of the same kind are running around the clock to spread the workload among two availability zones. In the case of high load, even more containers should be started for a short time. You need an ECS service for that.

Think of an ECS service as similar to an Auto Scaling group. An ECS service, as shown in figure 18.4, performs the following tasks: